

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

authority-chain

Provenance chain — statute to regulation to guidance to case, walked in order.

The chain descends from statute to practice.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalized "actual knowledge" standard.

branching forks the chain where authority splits.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501 COPPA, 1998

16 C.F.R. Part 312 FTC implementing rule

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan staff guidance

In re Epic Games · 2022 \$245M consent order

In re YouTube/Google · 2019 \$170M consent order

trail walks the chain as a breadcrumb.

01 STATUTE → 15 U.S.C. §6501 Verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.	02 REGULATION → 16 C.F.R. Part 312 FTC implementing rule.	03 GUIDANCE → FTC Six-Step Plan Cited in every consent order.	04 CASE Epic Games · 2022 \$245M consent order.
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pyramid weights the tiers by force.

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REGULATION

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FTC implementing rule.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Plan
Staff guidance, non-binding.

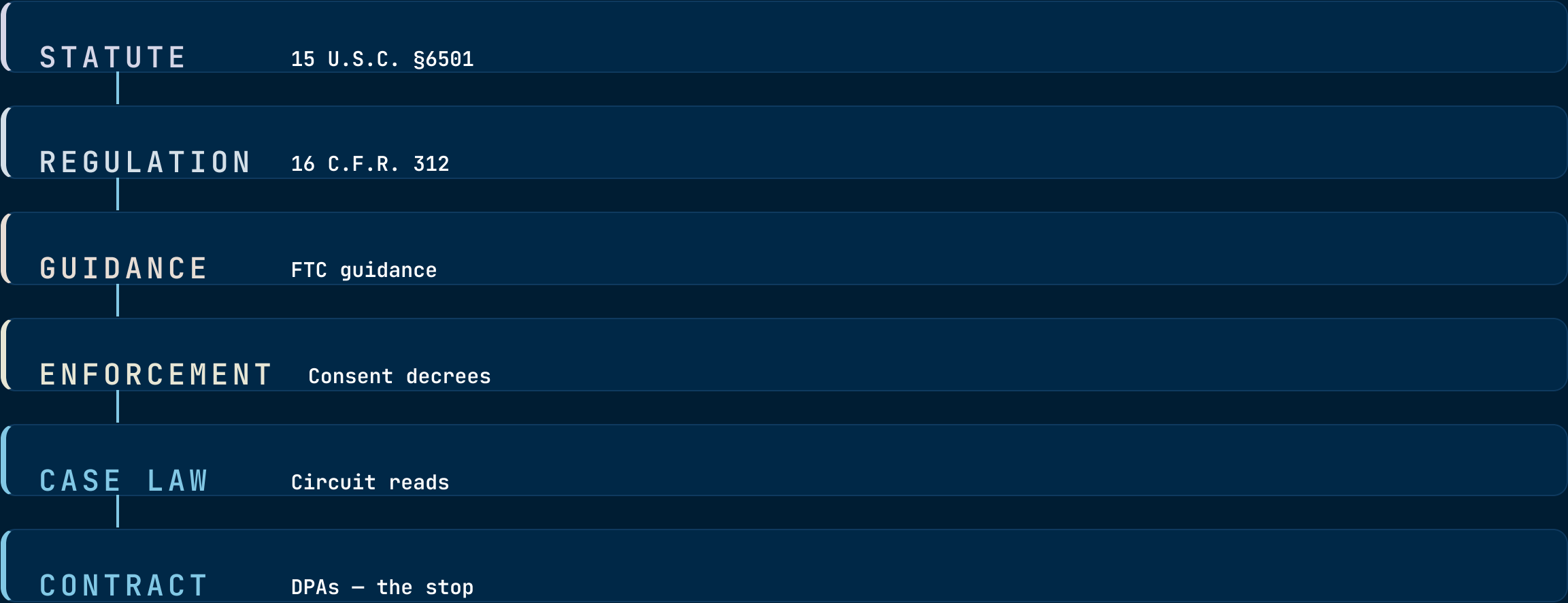
CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022
\$245M consent order.

bracket groups the tiers by actor.

TREATY	Charter of Fundamental Rights, Art. 8 EU primary law — protection of personal data is a fundamental right.
REGULATION	GDPR (EU) 2016/679 Directly applicable across all member states; sets the Art. 83 fine tiers.
GUIDANCE	EDPB Guidelines 04/2022 Harmonized methodology for calculating administrative fines.
DECISION	DPC v. Meta · 2023 €1.2B fine — the largest GDPR penalty to date.

Six tiers is the chain's ceiling.



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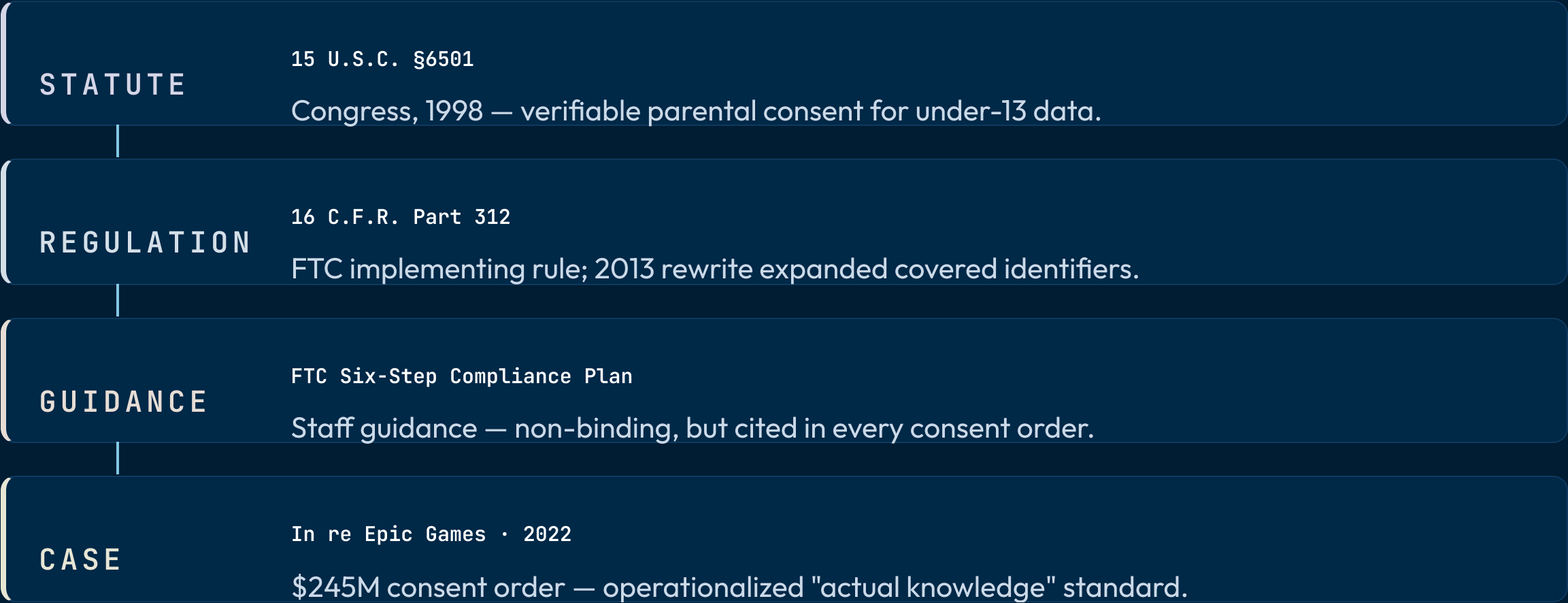
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CASE

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When NOT to reach for authority-chain.

Flat list of citations

If the rows have no tier hierarchy, use `list-criteria` or `regulatory-update`. authority-chain earns its chrome only when the descent from statute to case is the point.

Missing citation chip

The inline-code citation is the row's anchor; without it the gloss reads as opinion. Always cite, even for guidance and case rows.

Out-of-order tiers

The chain reads as a descent: statute first, case last. Reversing it or skipping a tier breaks the metaphor the audience is using to follow you.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`regulatory-update` — period-bounded changelog rather than a single rule's lineage

`list-criteria` — flat enumeration of requirements without tier hierarchy

`list-steps` — the rows are procedural steps rather than authority tiers